

# Steven Landers

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## AI-NATIVE ENGINEERING EXECUTIVE | DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS & SECURITY ARCHITECT

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*Engineering Leadership | Agentic Engineering | Distributed Systems | Blockchain Infrastructure | Security | MBA*

Engineering executive and hands-on architect with 20 years building products, leading senior engineering teams, and operating distributed, security-sensitive systems under high throughput, financial risk, and adversarial conditions. Former CTO of Forta. Currently in a stealth role at Sei Labs, after managing its Consensus & Execution team.

- **Leadership scope:** Led nine engineers as Director of Development / CTO of Forta, which raised \$23 million from a16z, and earlier led up to 21 engineers and UX professionals, including other managers, as a Director at Vonage.
- **AI transition:** Led the transition to agentic, spec-driven development at Sei Labs, keeping architecture, security, code review, and deployment under human ownership.
- **Technical depth:** Led the architecture and implementation of Sei's parallelized EVM and multi-proposer consensus platform, designed for roughly 200,000 transactions per second.
- **Zero to one:** Helped grow Forta from a laptop prototype to roughly 12,000 nodes, co-founded Netvote, and launched Pindrop's Cloud Protect fraud platform.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Sei Labs

2023–Present

#### L7 Engineer (Manager)

##### Stealth Project (current)

- Moved from managing the Consensus & Execution team into a stealth role on an unannounced Sei Labs project.

##### AI Transition

- Led the transition to agentic, spec-driven development as the primary way of building, combining agent skills and guardrails, repository-level instructions, automated validation, and human review.
- Built agent skills that turned machine-readable specs into pull requests, and workflows that generated code, ran tests, and investigated failures, while retaining ownership of architecture, security, and code review.

##### Consensus & Execution Team

- Managed the five-engineer consensus and execution team delivering Sei Giga incrementally to mainnet.

##### Sei Giga

- Led the design, prototyping, and rollout of Sei Giga, a multi-proposer architecture based on a modified Autobahn consensus protocol, designed for 5 gigagas per second (roughly 200,000 transactions per second).
- Drove technical design across consensus, execution, performance, and production rollout; co-authored two published papers on multi-proposer architecture and MEV (see Publications).

##### Sei Parallelized EVM

- Designed and implemented Block-STM parallel transaction execution for Sei's Cosmos-based EVM, making Sei the first parallelized EVM, and moved the design from prototype into production.
- Designed deterministic state-conflict detection, transaction validation, and conflict-resolution mechanisms, with sequential fallback to preserve correctness and mitigate pathological conflict and denial-of-service scenarios.

### OpenZeppelin / Forta

2020–2023

#### Director of Development / CTO, Forta

##### Forta

- Led Forta's nine-engineer team, owning architecture, roadmaps, design reviews, and performance management.
- Served as principal architect for Forta, a decentralized transaction-monitoring and threat-detection network that raised \$23 million from a16z, growing it from a laptop proof of concept to roughly 12,000 production nodes.
- Scaled the platform to more than 13,000 subscribers and more than 900 detection bots continuously monitoring transactions across Ethereum, BNB Smart Chain, Avalanche, Polygon, Arbitrum, and Optimism.
- Helped deliver the network protocol, cloud infrastructure, blockchain integrations, token launch, airdrop, and developer platform.

##### OpenZeppelin Defender

- Principal architect for Defender, a security-first DevSecOps platform for Web3 projects, designed as a scalable AWS serverless application supporting transaction operations, monitoring, automation, and blockchain infrastructure.
- Built systems for reliable JSON-RPC provider access, transaction retry and fee repricing, automated operational tasks, and transaction monitoring.
- Developed the decentralized monitoring proof of concept that became Forta and transitioned to leading Forta full time after funding.

## **Bishop Fox**

2019–2020

### **Principal Engineer & Software Manager**

- Managed a five-engineer team building a high-scale continuous attack-surface and vulnerability-detection platform for Fortune 500 customers.
- Designed and launched cloud-asset ingestion into security analytics systems, and built a domain-discovery system using SSL certificate analysis, WHOIS data, and remote asset lookups.

## **Netvote (side venture)**

2017–2019

### **Co-Founder & Technical Director**

- Co-founded an anonymous, tamper-resistant voting platform built on Ethereum and other distributed-ledger technologies, designing a protocol that integrated blockchain-based voting with modern election processes.
- Delivered production elections with Govurn, including the RChain cooperative board election (2018).

## **Pindrop**

2016–2019

### **Software Architect**

- Led a small team that designed, built, and launched Cloud Protect, a cloud-based fraud platform adopted by multiple large financial customers.
- Architected real-time fraud-detection, authentication, and ML pipelines used by major banks and enterprise call centers, helping evolve the data architecture toward approximately three billion analyzed calls per year.
- Led cross-functional efforts to scale concurrent call-processing capacity, and delivered recurring architectural briefings to engineering, sales, and executive audiences.

## **Vocalocity / Vonage**

2010–2016

### **Director of Software Architecture (previously Director of Development, Development Manager)**

- Promoted three times in six years, from Software Engineer to Director; led teams of as many as 21 software engineers and UX professionals, including other managers.
- Helped scale Vocalocity's business communications platform before and after its acquisition by Vonage, coordinating distributed teams in Atlanta, New Jersey, and Tel Aviv.
- Designed systems for provisioning, billing, authentication, emergency calling, call-event processing, and telecommunications routing.

## **Earlier Experience**

- **CGI Group, Consultant** | 2006–2010: Built and operated telecom, billing, portal, and set-top-box systems.

## **SKILLS & EXPERTISE**

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**Leadership:** Engineering leadership, technical strategy, roadmaps, performance management, managing managers, cloud and headcount budgets, distributed and cross-functional teams, executive briefings

**AI-native engineering:** Agentic and spec-driven development, agent skills and guardrails, machine-readable specs, automated validation, human-in-the-loop review, ML pipelines

**Systems:** Distributed systems, consensus protocols, parallel execution, blockchain architecture, security platforms, fraud detection, real-time and event-driven architecture, high-availability systems

**Languages & platforms:** Go, Python, TypeScript, Java, Solidity, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB, Kafka, Redis, Elasticsearch

## **EDUCATION**

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**MBA**, University of Georgia, 2012 | **BS, Computer Science**, University of Georgia, 2005

## **SELECTED PUBLICATIONS AND PROJECTS**

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- Sei Giga, co-author ([arxiv.org/abs/2505.14914](https://arxiv.org/abs/2505.14914))
- MEV in Multiple Concurrent Proposer Blockchains, first author ([arxiv.org/abs/2511.13080](https://arxiv.org/abs/2511.13080))
- Forta: [github.com/forta-network](https://github.com/forta-network) | [docs.forta.network](https://docs.forta.network) | [forta.org](https://forta.org)